

big difference between the “nominal exchange rate” offered by the banks, and the real rate of exchange.

**MONEY OFTEN  
COSTS TOO MUCH.**

**RALPH WALDO EMERSON, US ESSAYIST AND POET**



## THE EURO

After World War II, many European countries came together to promote peace and to be trading partners. The idea of instituting a single currency in the European Union to replace the different currencies of the member countries took hold. In 1999, the euro (€) was created for electronic transactions, and in 2002 coins and banknotes were issued in the countries of the “Eurozone.”



**There are 180 currencies recognized by the United Nations as legal tender.**